



Interstellar happening

Large Hadron Collider scientists explain how some of the ideas from Interstellar are already at work <http://dgit.in/LHCVideo>



Robot Teacher

Mike Rubenstein with two other researchers have built a \$10 robot that can help teach kids programming <http://dgit.in/RoboTeach>



Every month we highlight some aspiring tech writers and their spirited attempt to get published in the magazine. Let's have more!

Moving on from Bitcoins

Mining cryptocurrency is still a profitable venture if you know which coin to mine, you have the right hardware and you have the right miner software to complete the package.



Praneet Sah

Now that Bitcoins have been around for a long time, it has actually evolved a lot since then. It started off with CPU miners and then came the age of GPU miners and that eventually lead to ASIC miners. And ASIC miners made bitcoin mining almost impossible for the average computer

user (not even if you have a powerful rig). So now, what is the way out this? Well, the introduction of new coins have again made the GPU miners feasible. The best coin for mining with a GPU are litecoins (my personal choice) and of course, you can make money off of it although it might take some time and patience and correct settings and powerful GPUs.

The reason why a non-serious miner should focus on GPU mining is because you can't afford to lose your money and with those ASIC miners, you never know the future. Also you can use your GPU to play games and to do other things. Although we'll be focusing more on litecoins, but in case you can't use litecoins then you can give a try to "Dogecoins" or check out the chart at <http://www.coinwarz.com/> to find out the most profitable coin which is GPU oriented (script based).

As of now the conversion of litecoins into US Dollars is somewhere near to \$3.5 and you can never predict the future price, because of the fact that they keep on changing. Just take the example of bitcoins, they have even reached to 1000 USD and now they are somewhere near \$300-\$400.

When talking about mining LTC then there are two ways, you can either do it solo or in group. The solo mining is for only those who have got speed in thousands of Khash/s and have got some luck. Since most of us can't afford expensive rigs to reach thousands of Khash/s; therefore we'll be taking up group mining. For group mining I've got luck and better chances with "WeMineLTC.com". Simply go there and register yourself and then create a worker under your account. Generally worker's username must look like "AccountUsername.1" and try to keep password as simple as possible,

because if someone else mines for you then why not welcome them? Now we have got some basic things to start off with, now we need to configure miner on our computer.

The AMD powered GPU seem to be much better than the NVidia cards. Another thing to consider is that if you have a NVidia card and not using NVidia's method of mining then it can really lower down your mining speed by almost

100%. As the root of most of the miners we'll

be using the CGMiner as base (for AMD GPU's) and obviously would be writing

some batch files in order to run it. Do remember to use the "CudaMiner" if you have got NVidia powered GPU. Don't even think of touching "GUI Miner" because it's outdated, old and trash. Let's start off with configuring the miner.



Mining with an AMD Powered GPU

Firstly you would need to download "cgminer v3.5.0" ONLY because any version after it doesn't supports GPU mining and versions before it might have some bugs. Extract it somewhere and open notepad. Now type the following lines -

```
setx GPU_MAX_ALLOC_PERCENT 100
setx GPU_USE_SYNC_OBJECTS 1
cgminer.exe --script -o stratum+tcp://global.
wemineltc.com:3333 -u worker's_username -p
worker's_pass --gpu-platform 1 -d 0 -w 256 -v
1 -g 1 -l 1
```

In the above lines make sure to change the worker's_username and worker's_pass with the worker's detail that you got from wemineltc.com In case the above doesn't works then you may try to remove the things after your worker's password because every computer is different in terms of its power and you never know that what settings would work on which computer. Anyways a little googling might also help. Now you need to save this file as "any_name.bat" in the same folder where you extracted "cgminer v3.5.0". Don't forget the .bat in the end, because it help to run the